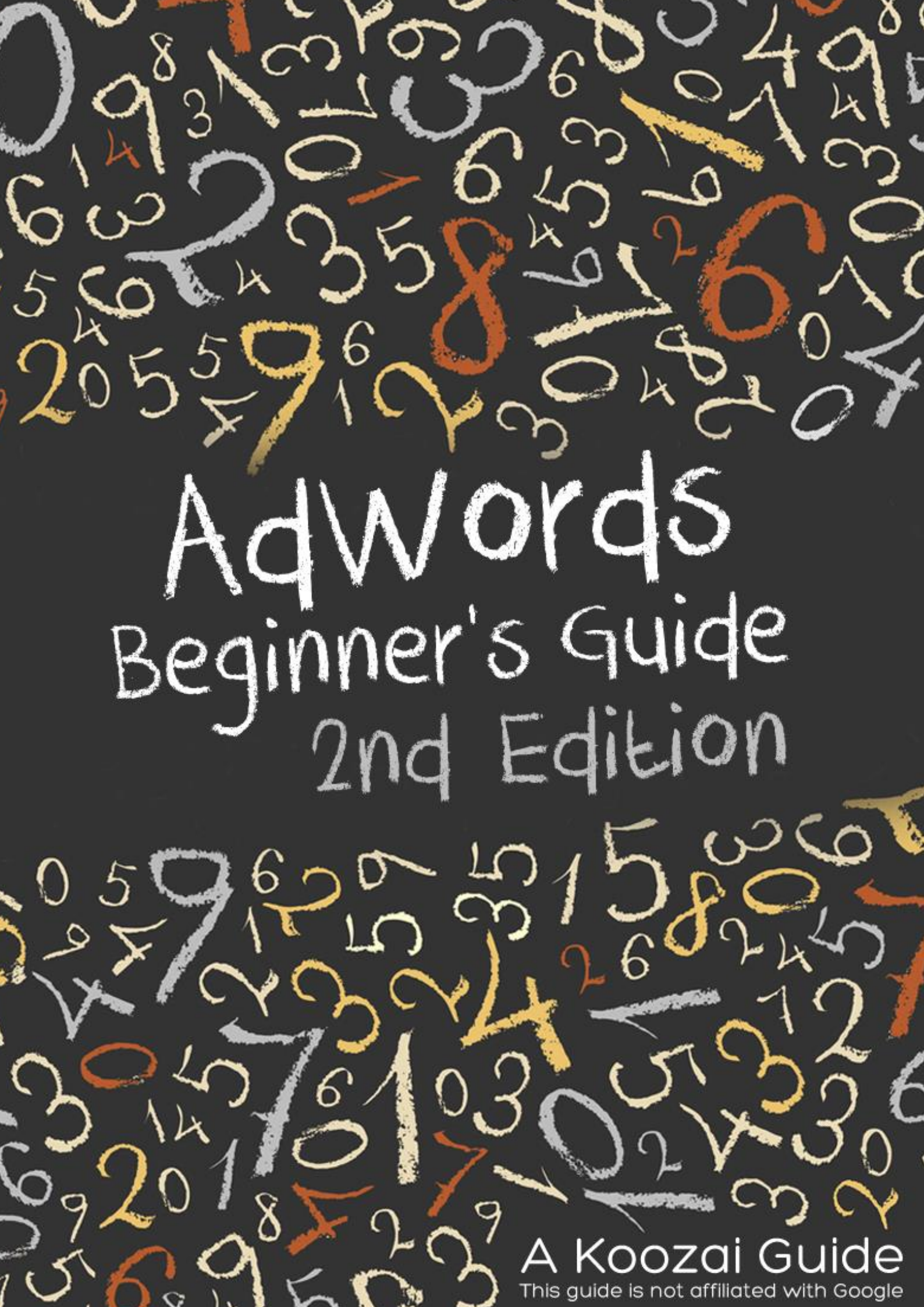




AdWords

Beginner's Guide

2nd Edition

A Koozai Guide

This guide is not affiliated with Google

AdWords Beginner's Guide – 2nd Edition

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A Little Bit About Koozai:

Koozai are a multi-award winning Digital Marketing Agency.

We're one of the UK's fastest growing technology companies having been ranked 23rd in the Deloitte Technology Fast50.

We help businesses connect with their customers online – providing a range of industry leading services from Organic Search Engine Optimisation (SEO) and Pay Per Click (PPC) Management, Social Media and Brand Management.

We thrive on building long lasting client relationships and delivering true value for money. We're passionate about what we do - and that shows in our work.

At Koozai, there are no lengthy contracts, just world class Digital Marketing. Koozai will help you build your brand online and achieve a ROI that can be clearly measured against your bottom line.



How To Get In Touch:

If you would like to get in touch with us, please visit the website (www.koozai.com) or use one of the methods below:



@koozai



sales@koozai.com



/koozai



/koozai

About The Authors:

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Working in new media for over 8 years, Oliver Ewbank has worked for a range of brands including eBay and SportBusiness.com on SEO, PPC and Social Media Management.

He has won awards for his SEO work and been featured in a number of publications, including Virgin online. He is one of two Digital Marketing Managers at Koozai who manage our paid search and SEO teams.

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Tara is an experienced SEO & PPC Specialist at Koozai. Having run campaigns for a wide variety of industries, her AdWords experience includes the Search Network, Remarketing, Display Advertising, YouTube Advertising, Product Listing Ads and much more!

She regularly contributes to the Koozai blog as well as having written guest posts for sites such as 123reg and OMN London. She has previously presented at On the Edge and OMN London, as well as Guest Lecturing at Bournemouth University.



About This Whitepaper:

If you are looking to advertise online then AdWords is the best place to start. You can get instant results and easily measure your return on investment. The best part is that you only pay if someone clicks on your ad.



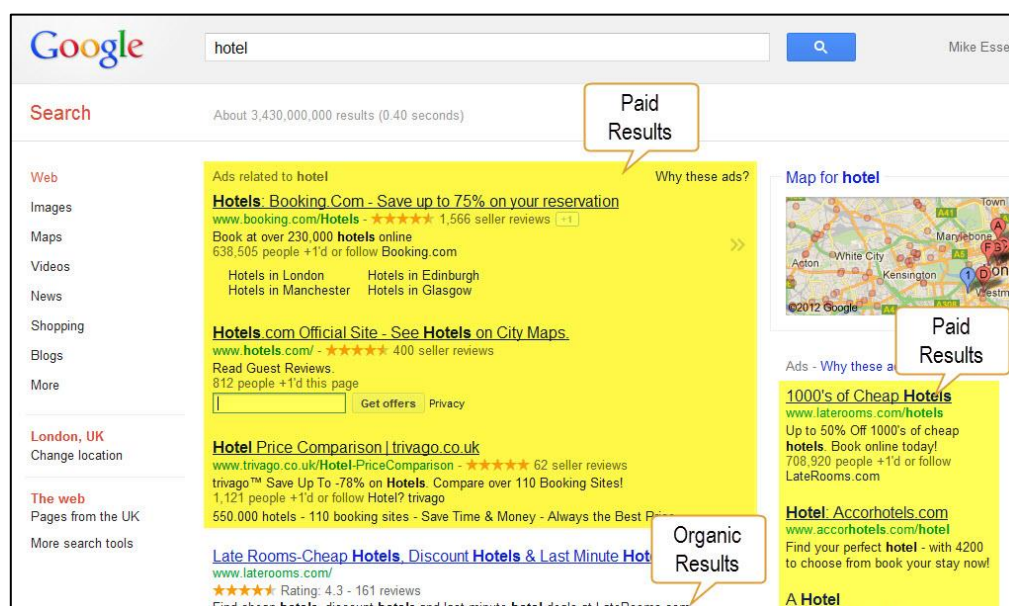
This guide will help you set up a basic AdWords campaign on the Search Network and understand which settings will give you the best performance from a brand new account.

If you are looking to use the Google Display network then we have an [additional whitepaper](#) which takes a specific look at this area.

How Does It Work?

AdWords PPC can work for any type of business. No matter what your budget, you can display ads on Google and their advertising network. A local pizza restaurant can target customers in their specific region and global brands can target users worldwide.

AdWords PPC is an automatic auction. You write ads and target relevant keywords. Then, a potential customer searches and ads with keywords related to their query will be displayed. The ads with the best bids and quality score (more on this later) will appear under the heading 'Sponsored Links', on the right-hand side or above the search results.



Advertising Reach

The biggest benefit to using AdWords is being able to target a huge range of customers. As well as having your ads shown on normal Google search results you can also make your ads appear:

- On other websites people visit (See [Networks section](#))
- On mobile phones, tablets, laptop and desktop devices (See [Devices section](#))
- To people in specific locations or who speak a specific language (See [Languages section](#))
- To specific audiences (See [Ad Scheduling section](#))

Creating An Account

Creating an account is deliberately easy. Simply go to Google.com/AdWords and hit the 'sign up now' button. You will need a Google account to verify the setup. If you need more assistance in this process you can always ring 0845 358 0038 for the official AdWords helpline at Google.

Once you have created an account you will be given a unique Customer ID number.

Keyword Research

Before you can create your first AdWords campaign you need to decide which keywords you want to use. The keywords you choose will help trigger your ads so it's important you get this part right.

To start with we would suggest writing down a basic list of keywords you think potential customers would use to find your product. Once you have a basic list of terms you can type these into the [Google Keyword Tool](#).

Find keywords
Based on one or more of the following:

Word or phrase

One per line

Website

www.google.co.uk/page.html

Category

Apparel

☐ Only show ideas closely related to my search terms [?](#)

[Advanced Options and Filters](#)

Locations: United Kingdom [✕](#)

Languages: English [✕](#)

Devices: Desktops and laptops

Search

If you are still struggling for ideas you have the option of putting in your website to see what keyword suggestions Google comes up with. The Keyword Tool will help you see how many searches are made each month and how competitive it is to bid on that specific keyword.

The below keyword tools are also very helpful:

- SpyFu: <http://www.spyfu.com>
- Keyword Eye: <http://www.keywordeye.com/>
- Wordstream: <http://www.wordstream.com/>
- Wordtracker: <http://www.wordtracker.com/>

Keyword Match Types

There are four main match types when you are bidding on keywords. So if you were bidding on "tennis shoes" this could appear as:

- [Exact] - the exact keyword you want to bid on i.e. tennis shoes
- "Phrase" - variants of the exact keyword i.e. buy tennis shoes
- Broad - other related searches i.e. buy tennis sneakers
- +Broad Modifier – the modifier cannot be changed i.e. tennis blue shoes

It's extremely important that you remember these match types when entering keywords as phrase or broad match keywords can sometimes attract inappropriate clicks, which will waste your budget. We would recommend creating a list of the keywords you would like to target using a spreadsheet, and grouping them into tightly targeted themes. These themes will later become your ad groups.

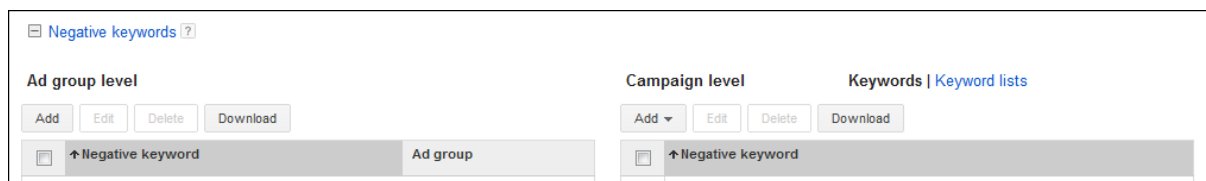
Negative Keywords

Negative keywords will help you stop inappropriate clicks on your ads which in turn will save you money and increase your quality score. It's important to choose your negative keywords carefully. Including the wrong negative keyword with the incorrect match type can lead to lost impressions and conversions.

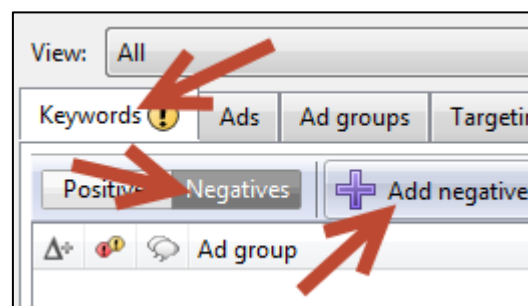
The match type is the same as with positive keywords i.e. if you were targeting 'tennis shoes' on broad.

- [Exact] - the exact keyword you want to exclude i.e. tennis balls
- "Phrase" - variants of the exact keyword you want to exclude i.e. second hand tennis shoes
- Broad - excluding other related searches i.e. Racket

You can add negative keywords at any stage in your campaign. To include negatives simply go to the main keyword tab at campaign level scroll down to find the negative keywords section below and expand by clicking "+".



You can also add negative keywords within AdWords Editor by going to the keywords tab and then clicking the 'negatives' tab:



A great way to find negative keywords is to note down anything in your keyword research that you don't want to rank for. You can also see what Google showed your adverts for, and then filter out anything you dislike via the Keywords tab. If you choose "Keyword details" and then "SEARCH TERMS > All" it will show you every keyword your advert showed for.

Creating A Campaign

Once you have completed your keyword research you are ready to create your first campaign. A campaign will represent a certain area (or product) of your site that you are looking to promote. For example if you are a clothes shop you could have a specific campaign for 'hoodies'.

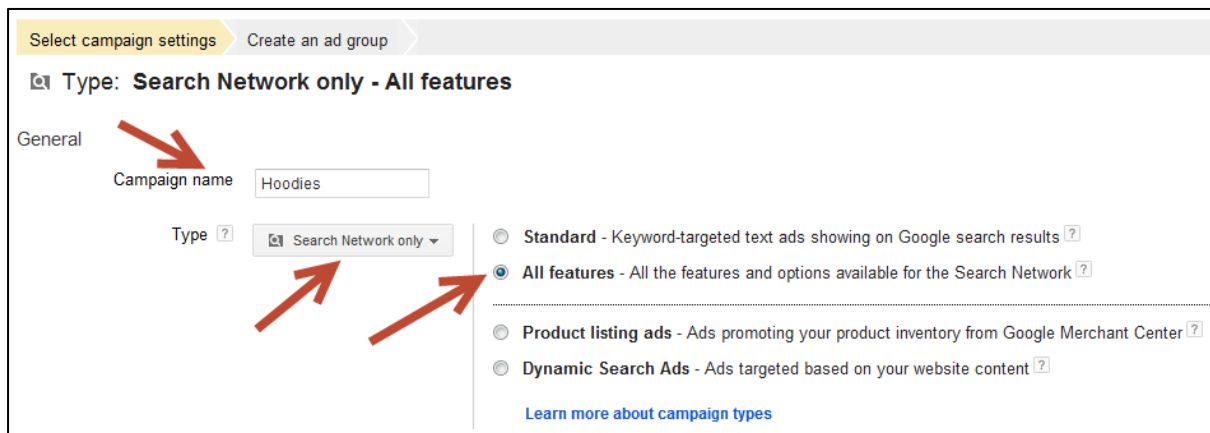
1. To create a campaign simply click the '+New campaign button'.
2. For a standard PPC campaign which will show your ads on Google search results pages, choose the 'Search Network Only' button
3. Name your campaign something which represents the area of your business it will advertise.

Campaign Settings

Campaign settings are extremely important to get right at this stage. If you amend the following sections correctly you are on the right track to delivering appropriate traffic.

Networks

Here you can choose if you want to opt into the Google Search partners. This includes other sites that use the Google search function on their domain. As it's your first campaign we would suggest opting out by selecting 'Search Network Only', and 'All Features':



The screenshot shows the 'Select campaign settings' step in the Google AdWords interface. At the top, there are two tabs: 'Select campaign settings' (active) and 'Create an ad group'. Below the tabs, the campaign type is set to 'Search Network only - All features'. Under the 'General' section, the 'Campaign name' is 'Hoodies'. The 'Type' dropdown is set to 'Search Network only'. To the right, there are four radio button options: 'Standard' (unselected), 'All features' (selected), 'Product listing ads' (unselected), and 'Dynamic Search Ads' (unselected). Each option has a help icon. At the bottom, there is a link 'Learn more about campaign types'.

Devices

All AdWords accounts now use Enhanced Campaigns which mean that all devices are targeted in the same campaign, and tablet devices are targeted as standard alongside desktop and laptops.

You can choose whether to target mobile devices and adjust this using your bid adjustment. Initially, all devices will be targeted within the campaign and Google will keep your mobile bids the same as your standard desktop bids.

The section in this guide titled 'Devices Tab' will explain how you can use your mobile bid adjustment to get the most out of your PPC advertising.

Locations & Languages

Choose which countries you'd like to target or exclude in your campaign at a basic level here, and then you can apply more granular targeting using the 'Locations Tab', which is expanded upon later in this guide.

You should also select the language you wish to target. It's always best to set the language settings to match the ad text of your campaign. If you are only going to have adverts in English then you should only target the English language with your campaign.

Locations

Locations ?

What locations would you like to target (or exclude) in your campaign?

☐ All countries and territories



☒ United Kingdom

☐ Let me choose...

Advanced search

For example, a country, city, region or postcode.

 Location options (advanced)

Languages

Languages ?

What languages do your customers speak?



English [Edit](#)

If you do wish to target different languages you can create adverts easily, simply by writing the text in that language. However the campaign settings must be changed and I'd only recommend targeting one language with each campaign.

If a country speaks multiple languages and you can write ad text in the right language, then you should still make a campaign for each language:

[Vente vins du Languedoc - Transport Gratuit, Livraison 48-72h](#)
www.lesvinsdusoleil.fr/
+ de 350 vins sélectionnés
[vins rosés du Languedoc](#) - [vins rouges du Languedoc](#) - [Vins Blancs du Languedoc](#)

Bidding And Budget

We would recommend manually setting your bids for clicks, as this allows you more control over how much you are prepared to pay for a click on a particular keyword.

You can set a default bid for the campaign at this point. This bid will be applied to the first ad group you create (which is the next step to setting up). Set this with consideration to the maximum amount you would be prepared to pay for a click on a keyword within this campaign. You can change bids at a later stage and place them at keyword level if you wish to have more control over bids for individual keywords.

The budget you set will be the maximum amount this particular campaign can spend on any individual day. Set this based on your resources and how much you would be prepared to spend in any single day. Your daily budget must be more than your maximum CPC bid.

Bidding and budget

Bidding option Basic options | [Advanced options](#)

☒ I'll manually set my bids for clicks

You'll set your maximum CPC bids in the next step.

☐ AdWords will set my bids to help maximise clicks within my target budget

Default bid £

This bid applies to the first ad group in this campaign, which you'll create in the next step.

Budget ☒ Individual budget

£ per day

Actual daily spend may vary.

Delivery Method

Here you have the option to display ads evenly over time or to show ads as quickly as possible. We would suggest showing them evenly over time, as it means you don't risk using your entire budget very quickly if there was a sudden rush for a product, or an issue with your adverts – such as a new keyword having a very high search volume.

Delivery method

☒ Standard: Display ads evenly over time

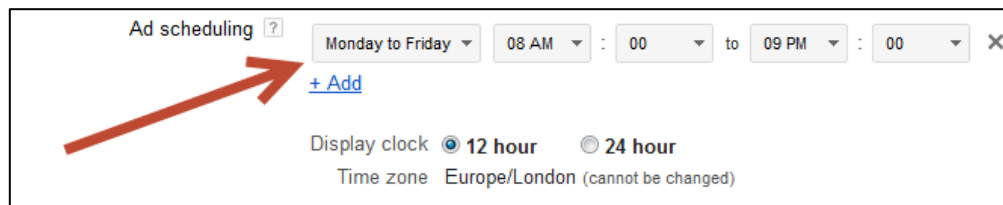
☐ Accelerated: Show ads as quickly as reasonably possible

[Save](#) [Cancel](#)

Ad Scheduling

Here you can schedule when you want your ads to appear. We would suggest not displaying ads all days and all hours. Consumers are less likely to make a purchase after 12pm at night and if you are running a B2B business it will be far less effective to advertise on the weekends.

Consider your product or service and your consumer lifestyle when you decide on your ad scheduling. This can be changed at a later date. Click 'Create Custom Schedule' and then choose the times and days you'd like your ads to run on:



Ad scheduling 

Monday to Friday 08 AM : 00 to 09 PM : 00 

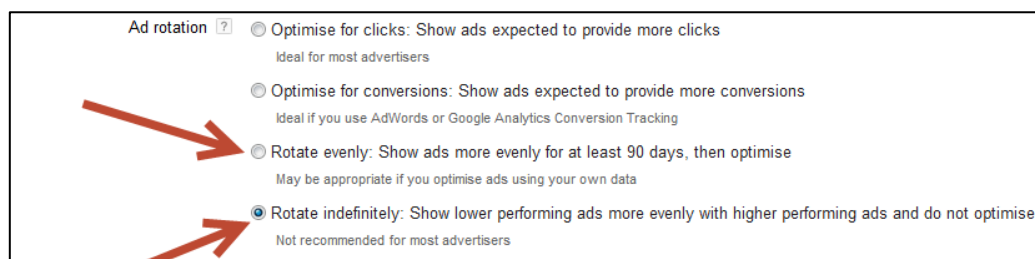
[+ Add](#)

Display clock ☒ 12 hour ☐ 24 hour

Time zone Europe/London (cannot be changed)

Ad Delivery

If you are going to actively optimise your account and conduct split testing then we would recommend using the 'Rotate Indefinitely' option for ad delivery, as this allows you to collect data on both ads evenly and then optimise them yourself. If you are not going to be split-testing them, then I'd recommend setting this as 'Rotate Evenly: show ads more evenly for at least 90 days, and then optimise as this option will optimise your ads for clicks based on at least 90 days of data.



Ad rotation 

☒ Optimise for clicks: Show ads expected to provide more clicks
Ideal for most advertisers

☐ Optimise for conversions: Show ads expected to provide more conversions
Ideal if you use AdWords or Google Analytics Conversion Tracking

☐ Rotate evenly: Show ads more evenly for at least 90 days, then optimise
May be appropriate if you optimise ads using your own data

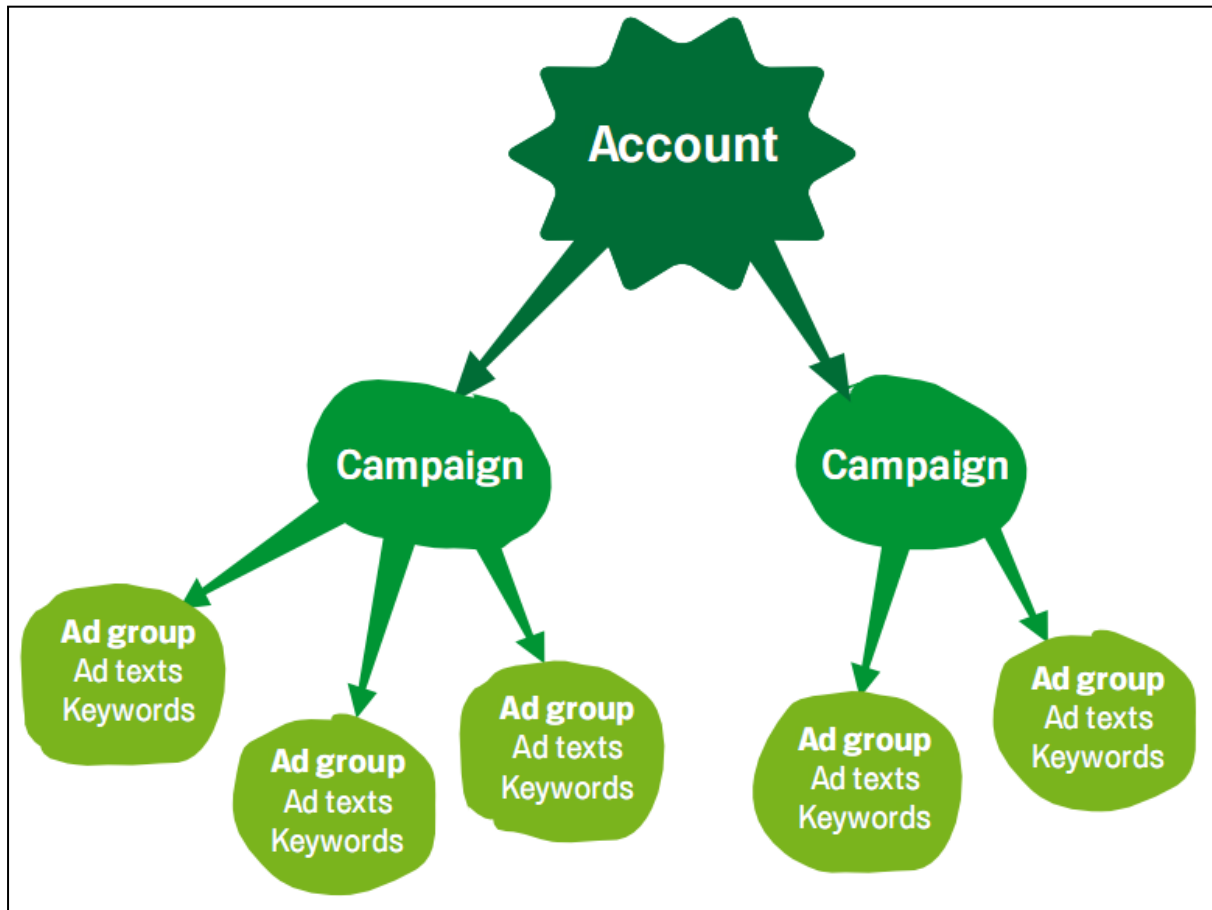
☒ Rotate indefinitely: Show lower performing ads more evenly with higher performing ads and do not optimise
Not recommended for most advertisers

Keyword Matching Options

Choosing 'Include plurals, misspellings, and other close variants' will allow Google to let your ads be triggered by close variations of your keyword. If you have keywords which users might easily misspell, such as a hotel name, then this option is beneficial. If your keywords are straight forward and unlikely to be misspelt then you might want to choose the 'Do not include close variants' option to ensure you have full control over the keywords which trigger your ads.

Account Structure

Having a well-structured account is the key to having a well optimised campaign. If you have organised campaigns you will have relevant ads which will deliver better results (see diagram below).



[Source](#)

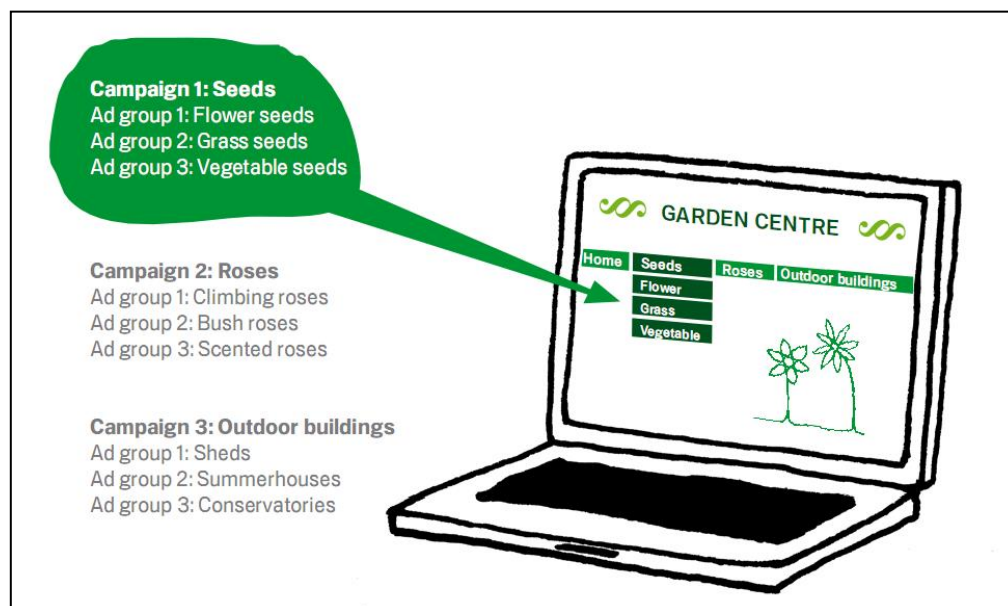
When you structure an account there are three main levels to consider: account, campaign and ad group. So far we've set up our account and campaign so we now need to create ad groups, with ad texts and keywords.

Ad Groups

Once you have created your campaign you are ready to start adding ad groups with your keywords. It's important to remember that the ad groups need to be themed so the keywords match the ad text. So for example if you have a 'hoodies' campaign you would then have an ad group for 'personalised hoodies', 'plain hoodies' and 'girls hoodies'.

By grouping your keywords into tightly themed ad groups you can make sure the ad text always matches the keywords. For example the ad group 'Personalised Hoodies' will then have a list of keywords including 'personalised hoodies', 'personalised hoodies uk' and 'personalised hoodies for kids' etc. In an ideal world, you should aim for one keyword per ad group and ensure the ad text for that keyword is tailored to match it.

You should refer to the keyword research you conducted earlier and group these keywords into themes which will become your ad groups.



[Source](#)

Ensuring your ad group has ad text which is tailored to the keywords within the ad group will increase your Quality Score.

Quality Score is a measurement of several factors including how relevant your ad is to the keyword and the destination page of the advert. Quality Score is calculated using the following factors:

- Your keyword's past Click through Rate (CTR)
- Your Display URL's past CTR
- Your account history
- The quality of your landing page
- Your keyword/ad relevance
- Your keyword/ search relevance
- Geographic performance
- Your ad's performance on a site (Display Network)
- Your targeted devices

If you have a high Quality Score you will be rewarded with higher ranked ads and you will pay less per click. Because of this, it's vital your destination page is relevant to your keyword, - e.g. an advert about boots should point to a page about boots, not just shoes.

AdWords Editor

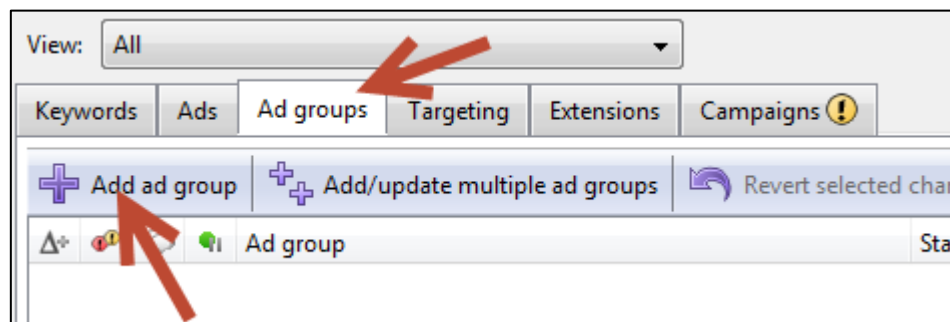
We would recommend creating your ad groups and structuring the rest of your account using [AdWords Editor](#).

AdWords Editor is a free tool for managing and optimising your campaigns offline. You can download your account and make quick changes with powerful editing tools, then upload it directly to AdWords. This tool can save you huge amounts of time as you can add multiple keywords and ad groups at once.

If you do not already have AdWords Editor you should download it now, and download your account within it, so that you can structure your account offline and post it live once you are ready.

To create a new ad group in AdWords Editor:

1. Go to the campaign you have created which will be listed down the left hand side, and then once you have selected the campaign click ad groups tab, and then 'Add Ad Group':



2. Name your ad group something which represents the keywords you are going to have within it, for example 'personalised hoodies'
3. Set your ad group maximum CPC bid (if you haven't already done this when you set up the new campaign)
4. If you are targeting mobile, you can also set your mobile bid adjustment here. We will go into more detail on what to consider when setting your mobile bid adjustment in the 'Devices Tab' section of this guide.

A screenshot of the 'Edit selected ad groups' form in AdWords Editor. The form has several fields: 'Ad group name' (with the value 'Personalised Hoodies'), 'Status' (a dropdown menu set to 'Enabled'), 'Default max. CPC bid' (with the value '1.09'), 'Display Network max. CPC bid', 'Max. CPM bid', 'CPA bid', 'Mobile bid adjustment' (a percentage field), and 'Display Network custom bid type' (a dropdown menu set to 'None'). Red arrows point to the 'Ad group name' field, the 'Default max. CPC bid' field, and the 'Display Network custom bid type' dropdown menu. At the bottom left, there is a small text that says 'All bids are shown in GBP'.

5. Click into the ad group you have created from the menu on the left hand side of the page, and then once you have selected it go to the Keywords tab, and then click 'Add keyword' and type your keywords for that particular ad group (all your 'personalised hoodies' keywords for this example).

We would recommend setting your destination URLs at ad level, rather than keyword level, so you can ignore this field for now. Your default Max CPC bid will automatically be the one you entered at ad group or campaign level earlier in the process.

If you would like to set specific bids at keyword level then you can set them at this point. It is important to remember to select your match types for each keyword. If you are new to AdWords we would recommend sticking with phrase and exact match types and not using broad match for now:

Status	Keyword	Type	Max. CPC (GBP)	Quality Score
Pending review	personalised hoodies	Phrase	1.09	
Pending review	personalised hoodies	Exact	1.09	
Pending review	personalised hoodies uk	Phrase	1.09	
Pending review	personalised hoodies uk	Exact	1.09	

Messages: 1
Warning: This keyword is the same as another keyword in the ad group with a different match type.

Edit selected keywords

Keyword: personalised hoodies

Match type: Phrase

Max. CPC bid (GBP): <default>

6. You should repeat this process as many times as necessary to create individual ad groups for each of your keyword themes.

It is important never to have the same keyword in multiple ad groups. AdWords does not read punctuation, so if you use a hyphen in your keywords this will be interpreted as a space, meaning there is no reason for having hyphenated and non-hyphenated version of your keywords.

Ad Text

Once you have structured your campaign, ad groups and keywords it's important to have matching ad text.

Organic Chocolate	Headline
www.thorntons.co.uk/	Display URL
Chocolate Gifts Delivered Direct.	Description line 1
Buy The Perfect Gift Online Now.	Description line 2

The maximum character limit for the headline is 25 characters and the maximum for the display URL and description lines 1 and 2 are 35 characters. We would suggest using the main keyword i.e. 'Personalised Hoodies' in the headline and once in the description as this will make the words stand out in bold (if they match the search query) and it will also contribute to your Quality Score.

Your display URL must be your domain but you can include a few words of your choice after it, so you if you were a chocolate shop in Hampshire you might write www.best-chocolates.co.uk/hampshire or if the ad was for white chocolate you could try www.best-chocolates.co.uk/white-chocolate.

Other ways to make your ad copy perform well include:

- Highlighting your USP
- Including prices
- Including offers (i.e. free delivery)
- Including a call to action

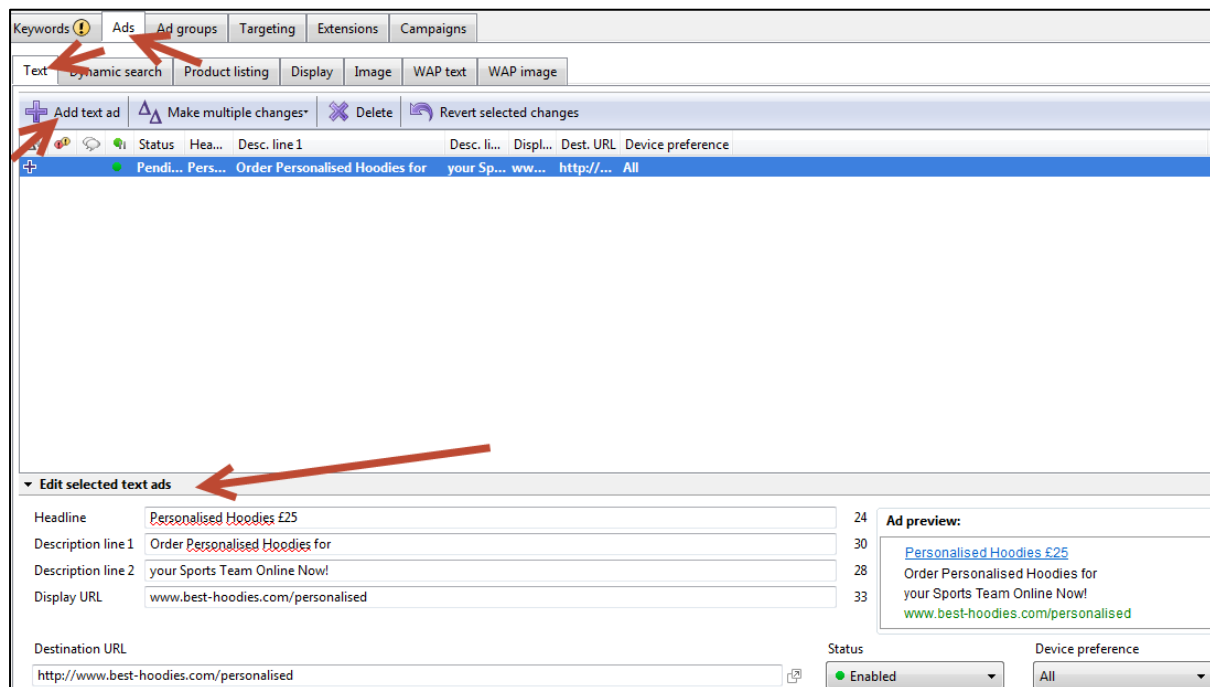
Although if you do include prices / offers you need to ensure these are correct in the future as if they are wrong your ads may be disapproved by Google, which means they will not run.

Your Destination URL is the page you are going to send your user to on your website – this must be accurate and work correctly. Choose your landing page to match the keyword and ad text of the ad group as best as possible, as this is most likely to result in a conversion because you are bringing the user straight to what they are looking for.

We would always suggest having at least two different ads running for each ad group. This way you can test which ad performs the best and create a new version to increase the Click through Rate.

Koozai® Award Winning Digital Marketing. Utilise Our Expertise Online Today. www.koozai.com/digital-marketing	Version A
Koozai.com Highly Accredited Digital Agency No Long Contract & Low Monthly Fees www.koozai.com/digital-marketing	Version B

To set up your ads using AdWords Editor, ensure you still have the ad group selected from the menu on the left hand side of the page, then go to the ads tab. Ensure you are on the 'Text' ad tab, and then click '+Add text ad'. You then need to write your ad text and enter your destination URL in the boxes below where it says 'Edit selected text ads':



You should create two ad variations for every ad group to allow for split testing. For example try one which mentions the price of your product and one which does not.

Context Bid Adjustments

All AdWords campaigns are now Enhanced Campaigns, which means you can tailor your ads more effectively for different devices, time of day, and locations.

Bid Adjustments

Your bid plays a part in determining your Quality Score, which in turn determines how high up in the results your ads will appear.

Bid adjustments are a percentage adjustment of your standard bid. For example if your bid adjustment for mobile devices was -10% and your standard desktop bid was £1.00, then your mobile bid would be £0.90. You can set bid adjustments for different devices, time of day, and locations.

Devices Tab

Within the Devices tab in the AdWords interface, you can set bid adjustments for mobile devices.

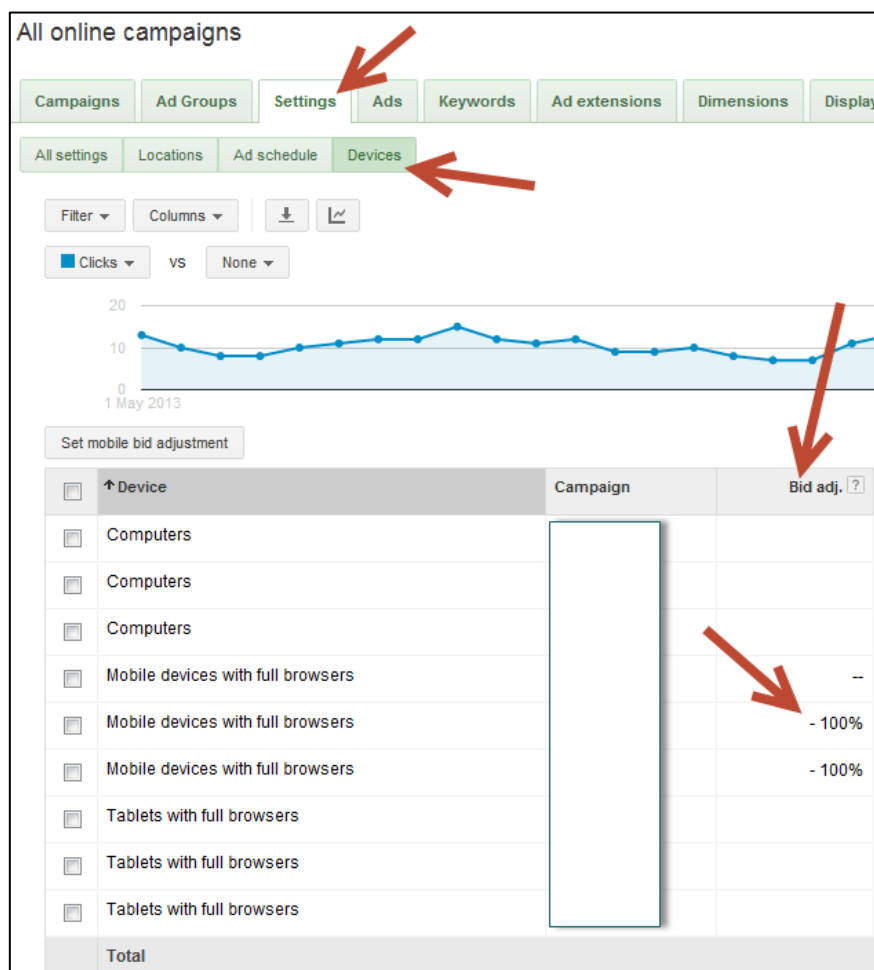
If you do not want to target mobile devices at all, set your bid adjustment at -100%.

Tablet devices are targeted as part of desktop and laptop devices, so you can not set a bid adjustment for these.

When deciding whether to target mobile devices, consider whether a user can easily complete a conversion on your site using a mobile device? If not then do not bid on mobile devices.

Mobile traffic is generally cheaper than desktop traffic, so your bid adjustment on mobile devices should be a minus percentage of your standard desktop bid. A good place to start is -30%.

In the example below, the campaigns are not bidding on mobile devices:



You can set device bid adjustments at campaign and ad group level.

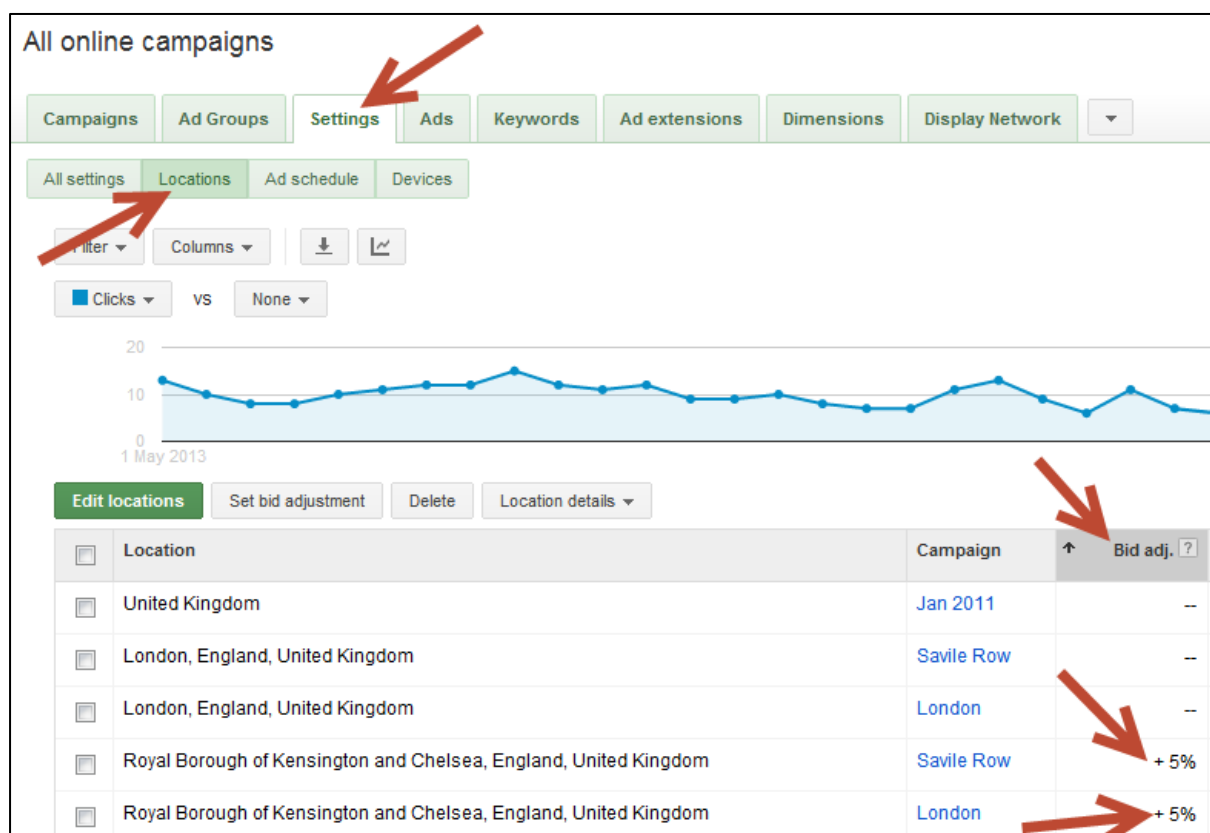
Locations Tab

You can set bid adjustments for locations based on the searcher's IP address.

For example if you were an estate agent with three offices in Hampshire, you could increase your bids within a one mile radius of each of your offices.

Having an increased bid in a location where users are more likely to come into your office and enquire means that you have a greater chance of having your ads seen by those users and so a greater chance of conversion.

In the example below, you can see we have increased the bids at campaign level for the areas of Chelsea:



Scheduling Tab

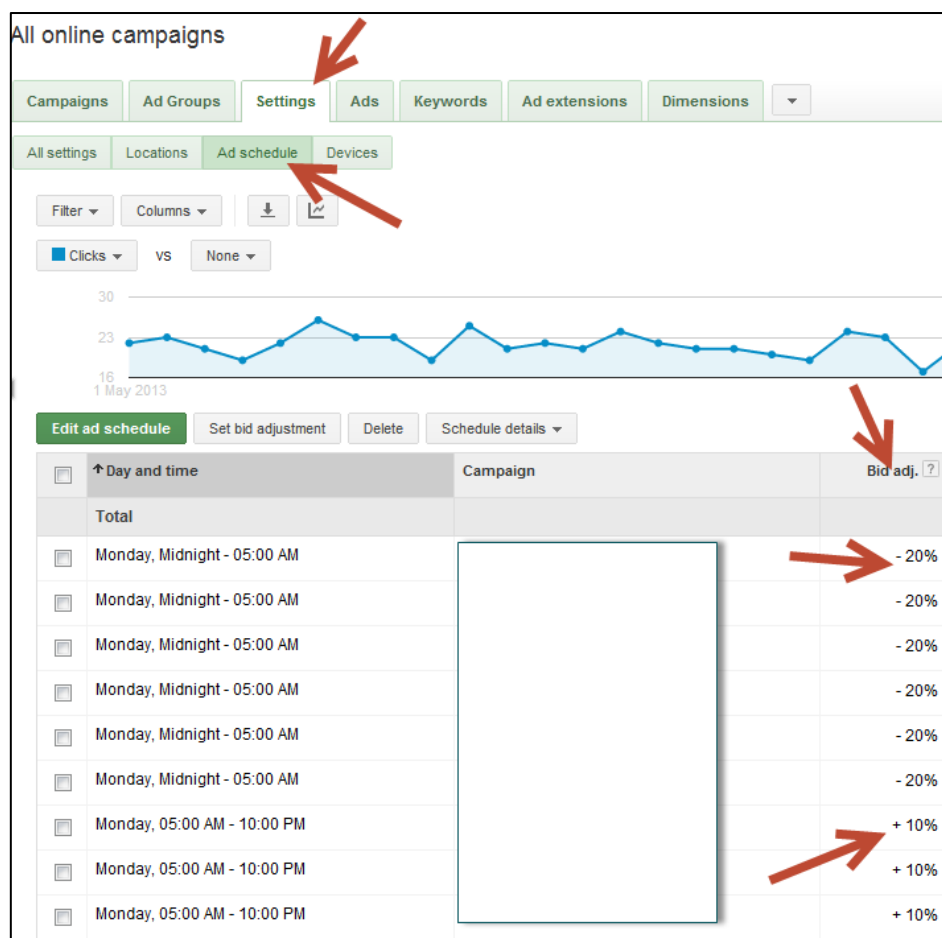
We previously discussed setting the time of day your adverts will run and it's also possible to change how much you bid at different times within this range.

Setting bid adjustments at different times of day allows you to increase or decrease your bids and visibility at certain times of day, when clicks might be more of less valuable to you.

For example if someone is searching for a café between 12pm and 1pm they are likely to be looking for somewhere local they can stop for lunch. If you are advertising you could increase your bids at these times of day so your ad is more visible because users who click on it at this time are more likely to convert.

Similarly, you can ensure your ad spend isn't wasted when you don't need it to be. For example if you are a recruitment agency which is always busy on a Monday morning, but then quiet on a Monday afternoon, you could decrease your bids on a Monday morning or simply stop your ads running on Monday mornings.

In the example below, we have increased and decreased bids during time periods when users tend to convert best via the website, based on data from the [Dimensions tab](#):



Ad Extensions

Ad extensions can increase your Click through Rate by up to 20% because they give potential consumers another reason to click on your ad.

They also take up additional space on the page but cost the same as a regular click so they provide additional value to you as an advertiser.

Call Extensions



Call extensions allow Google to display a 'call' button directly with your ad where users can click on the icon directly from a mobile device and call your business.

Google are moving towards the retirement of traditional call extensions, so it is highly recommended that you use a Google Forwarding number when setting up your call extensions, as these types of call extensions tend to get more exposure in results than the traditional kind.

Google Forwarding Number Call Extensions:

- Cost the same as a click on mobile devices
- Still show on tablet and desktop devices, but do not cost the advertiser anything if dialled as a result of being seen on desktop or tablet devices
- Cost the caller the same as your normal number would cost

Set your call extensions at campaign level if you only have one phone number. Alternatively if you have multiple departments you could set them at ad group level. For example if you are an estate agent with a direct line for sales and a separate line for lettings, you could have a call extension unique to the sales ad groups and a separate one for the lettings ad groups.

Set your Google Forwarding Number Call Extensions to be counted as conversions if the call lasts for a specific duration, by choosing this option when you set them up.

You should schedule your call extensions so that they only show when your business is open and someone is there to take the call. This ensures you do not pay for click-to-calls when no one is present to answer the call.

To implement call extensions, go to the Ad Extensions tab and select call extensions.

Location Extensions

Location extensions help local businesses display their business address and phone number with the ad text. Text ads with this extension have been reported by Google to increase CTR by up to 10%.

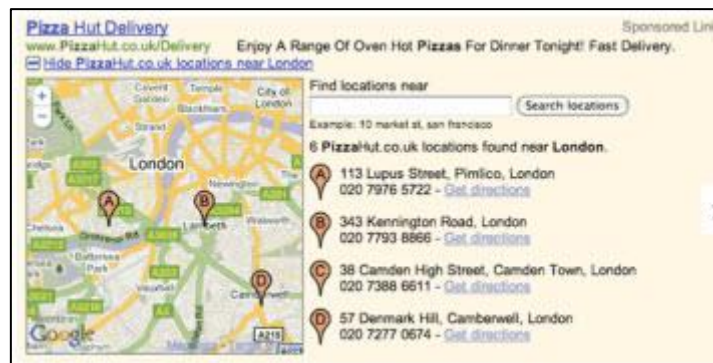
They are easy to set up. You can connect your Google Places account to your campaign or add an address manually. The extensions can appear in search results as well as on Google Maps and the Display Network.

Best Practice:

- Essential for any local business using AdWords
- Works well on mobile ads (2/3 mobile searches are local)
- You can share location extensions across campaigns
- Where possible select your own default icon from your uploaded images
- On mobile devices utilise click-to-call location extensions

Multiple Addresses for Location Extensions

Some local companies will want to display all their nearby locations to the user. This is now possible with 'multiple addresses'. You can show as many relevant stores in your ad as possible which dramatically increases your CTR and conversions.



Best Practice:

- Recommended for any small to large chains with multiple locations

Sitelink Extensions

Lets you promote more pages in addition to your landing page.

Sitelinks are probably the most used extension of the lot. They are easy to set up and are almost always guaranteed to increase CTR. Sitelinks simply let you include links to other pages in addition to the main landing page.

Once you switch to enhanced campaigns you can also target at ad group level and schedule your sitelinks for promotions. You can choose which sitelinks work best by using advanced reporting to optimise the ads further.



Best Practice:

- Use for high converting sections of your website
- Schedule for peak times of the day
- Use advanced reporting to test and optimise

Third Party Sitelink Extensions

On occasions it is possible to have sitelinks to your social properties. This can be a good option for brand building as you can gain new Twitter Followers and Facebook Fans which you can then remarket to.

Third-party links: In limited circumstances, sitelinks may point to third-party sites such as your Google+ page, Facebook page, Twitter, YouTube or LinkedIn. If doing so, the link text must be descriptive of what someone would find on that landing page. For example, "Watch our video on YouTube" should lead to your video on YouTube.

Best Practice:

- Don't use for direct sales
- Review the success in sitelink advanced reporting

Social Extensions

Linking your Google+ page to your AdWords account can automatically show social annotations in enhanced campaigns. Enabling social extensions on your PPC campaign will show all the +1's your brand has received which in turn will make it more likely that a user who views your ad could see that one of their friends has suggested it.

Last year Google reported that advertisers have seen as much as a 20% increase in CTR from using this extension. If you have a large following on Google+ it is well worth a go.



Best Practice:

- Be active on Google+ and populate your page with shareable content
- Build up a credible list of followers for your company
- The domain linked to Google+ must match your AdWords account

Seller Ratings Extensions

Seller Ratings Extensions allow you to attach your star rating from Google Shopping. Having a good star rating will let users know that you are well rated by customers. This will instil trust in the user and you are more likely to entice a click.



Best Practice:

- Build up a credible star rating and make sure customers receive excellent service
- Your company name and domain URL should be consistent across all review sites

App Extensions

This relatively new extension does what it says on the tin. Smartphone users can click an extension in your ad and directly download the app from iTunes or Google Play. If the user already has the app, the extension can prompt a deep link into the application.

This extension is ideal for app sellers who want to increase conversions or to direct traffic to a relevant section of the app itself.



Best Practice:

- Ideal for app sellers
- Use specifically for downloads or reviews
- Only use on mobile ads
- Bid aggressively as there will be limited ad space

Email Extensions

First released in 2012 this extension gives you the option of including an email sign-up box in your text ad. This is ideal for anyone who has a newsletter and wants to build a community of users who they can push and remarket content to.

If it's something you are keen on testing you can contact your account manager and ask to be Whitelisted.

 **Low Cost Business Loans - Apply online in less than 20 min**
www.fundingcircle.com/BusinessLoans
Get £5k-£1m, Need Turnover £100k+
 [Privacy](#)

Best Practice:

The extension is set at campaign level and you need to provide the following to run the extension:

- Fields you want to show in the ads i.e. email, name, zip code (the maximum is 2 fields)
- The website privacy policy URL
- The address where you want the data to be sent

Offer Extensions

Offer extensions help you promote your latest offers visually in your text ad. The link will look like a sitelink extension but it will say 'View offer'. Once a user clicks the 'View offer' link they will go to a Google landing page where they can print the offer or save it to their [offers page](#).

You can run offer extensions on all devices and schedule promotions to target consumers at peak shopping times. This feature can run with other extensions and you can get extra ad space for the same cost.

This extension can dramatically improve your Click through Rate and can be used with a range of offers (Free Postage & Packaging, Free Consultation, Buy 1 Get 1 Free, Free Download).



Best Practice:

- Ideal for ecommerce
- The offer must have a promotion code
- The offer must be accurate and not misleading
- If you have a Google Places account linked to AdWords you can show redeem locations
- Test and monitor CTR

Image Extensions

Image Extensions are the latest extensions to be released by AdWords. Simply put, this feature allows you to add visual elements to your search ads. This extension is still in early stages of Beta testing but so far results have shown a 10-20% CTR uplift.

Set at ad group level, you need to make sure the images represent all the keywords in your specific ad group. It is best practice to create a themed ad group for each picture and the images will need to meet standard guidelines for quality and relevance. To test this new feature, simply complete [this online form](#).



Best Practice:

- Best used for visual products or services (i.e. cars & hotels)
- Images must be accessible 1-2 clicks from landing page
- Images must be a JPEG with minimum size of 320x180px and maximum size of 640x360
- Images should have an aspect ratio of 16.9 and you can use [this free online tool](#) to determine your ratio
- Don't use logo's or animated images
- You must have appropriate rights to the image

Dynamic Search Ad Extensions

Dynamic Search Ads automatically show your ad based on the content on your website. When a search term matches an appropriate page from your domain the AdWords system will automatically create sitelinks. Visually this is no different than a normal sitelinks advert.

Product Listing Ads

These were previously called "Product Extensions". Product listing ads are a great AdWords feature for ecommerce businesses.

Since product Extensions have ceased, Product Listing Ads (PLAs) are the only way to get your product images and prices featured alongside your paid search ads:



Google look at a user's search query and determines whether it is related to a product. If it is, they will show PLAs which match the users search query. There is no keyword targeting with PLAs (except negative keywords), however you can narrow down your targeting by using [product targets](#), which specify which products should trigger your PLAs. You might want to use this function if you want to exclude certain products with very low profit margins from triggering product listing ads because it wouldn't be cost effective.

PLAs cost the same as regular PPC ads and work on a CPC basis. In my experience, they can actually be cheaper than standard CPC ads because there is often less competition, depending on what vertical you are advertising in.

To use PLAs you must have an active Google Merchant Centre account, which contains an XML or .txt data feed of all your products. For this to work, your products must have SKU numbers and be available to purchase via your website. You must include as much information in the attribute fields on the data feed as possible.

The Product Listing Ads are managed via your AdWords account, which needs to be linked to your Google Merchant Centre account. Product Listing Ads must be set up in their own campaigns, which means you can allocate a set daily budget to them.

You can find them alongside your regular AdWords campaigns, and we would advise naming them something with PLA at the start, so that you can easily filter to see only PLA data and also filter to exclude this data from your other campaigns.

Tips for using PLAs effectively:

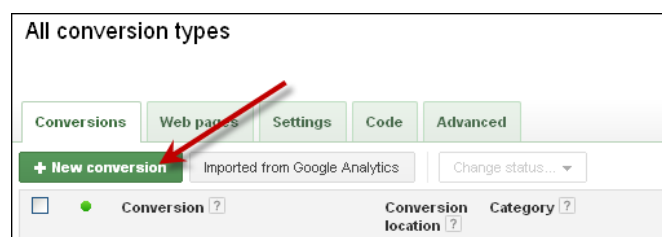
- Use lots of negative keywords and review the search query report often
- Use product targets to target only the products which are profitable for you
- Structure your campaigns well, with a separate PLA campaign for different sectors of your business, for example if you are a clothing retailer you should have a PLA campaign for men's clothing and a separate PLA campaign for women's clothing, and within each campaign you should have ad groups for each clothing category – this allows you to tailor your product targets and your bids
- Use the column in your feed titled 'AdWords labels' to rate each product with an ROI score, so when you are optimising and setting bids, you can see whether they have a high ROI and are worth bidding more, or whether it's better just to exclude that product
- Keep your feed updated or your ads will stop running

If your product listing ads aren't showing:

- Try increasing your bids
- Check that your country targeting settings are the same in both your AdWords and Google Merchant Centre account
- Check your data feed has been updated
- Check all fields are filled in on your data feed
- Check all products have correct SKUs

Conversion Tracking

If you are new to AdWords then conversion tracking is essential. It can help you see which keywords best lead to sales. Conversion tracking works by putting a small snippet of HTML code on the page customers see after they complete a purchase.



To generate the code simply go to 'Tools and Analysis', 'Conversions' and select 'New Conversion'. Simply name the conversion something that matches the campaign name. The code will need to be pasted between the body tags (<body></body>) of the page.

You can also [import goals](#) from Google Analytics if you [link your](#) AdWords and Analytics accounts. If you do not link your AdWords and Analytics accounts, your AdWords PPC traffic will be recorded as organic traffic.

Optimisation

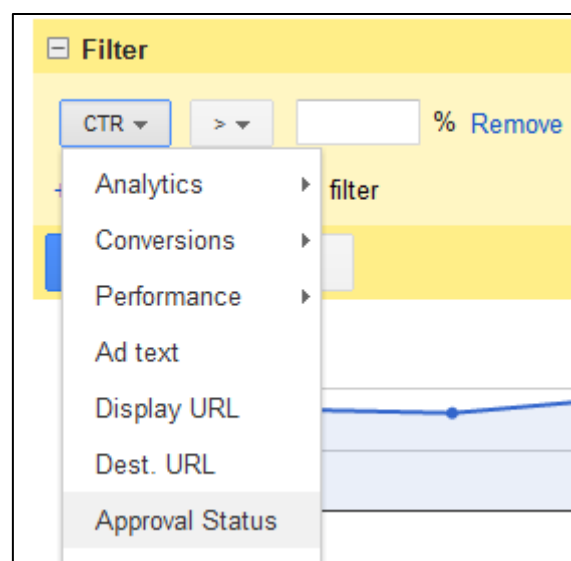
By now you should have the solid foundation for a successful AdWords campaign. However, once you set the campaign live the real work needs to begin.

An AdWords account cannot be left unattended so keep a close eye on the data that comes in. There are a number of things to you should check and tweak regularly to optimise an AdWords account. Important checks include:

Ad Status

Are your ads running right now? AdWords guidelines are becoming increasingly complex and change on a regular basis. For this reason you may find your ads disapproved on occasion. Check to make sure they're not by filtering by ad status.

1. Go to the ads tab
2. Click Filter
3. Click Create Filter
4. Choose Approval Status as your criteria
5. Ensure only Disapproved, Approved Limited, and Under Review are ticked



If you then hover over the speech bubble in the status column for each keyword, it will tell you why your ad isn't running, which should give you an idea of what you need to do to fix it.

Status ?	% Served ?	Clicks ?	Impr. ?	CTR ?	Avg. CPC ?	Cost ?	Avg. Pos. ?	Conv. (1-per-click) ?	Cost per click ?
		98	4,840	2.02%	£0.49	£48.32	2	0	£0.0
Approved	0.0	Ad showing now? No Ad tested with: Keyword: +mesh +banner Edit Location: England, United Kingdom Edit Test again							
Approved	0.0								
Approved	0.0	Reasons Your campaign budget doesn't enable additional spending today.							
Approved	0.00%	0	0	0.00%	£0.00	£0.00	0	0	£0.0

Keyword Status

Similarly to ads, keywords can become disapproved when they don't comply with AdWords guidelines. Filter in the same way you would for your Ads but this time in the Keyword tab and select Filter, Create Filter, and then choose Status. Make sure only Keyword Disapproved is ticked.

All online campaigns

Campaigns
Ad Groups
Settings
Ads
Keywords
Ad extensions
Auto targets
Dimensions
Display Network

All but deleted keywords
Segment
Filter
Columns
Download
Search

Filter

Status
Eligible
Eligible: limited
☒ Not triggering ads: critical issues
Not eligible to run

Eligible
low quality score
☒ Keyword disapproved
Keyword paused or deleted

Low search volume
Below first page bid
Campaign or ad group paused or deleted
Campaign pending or ended

Show diagnosis status

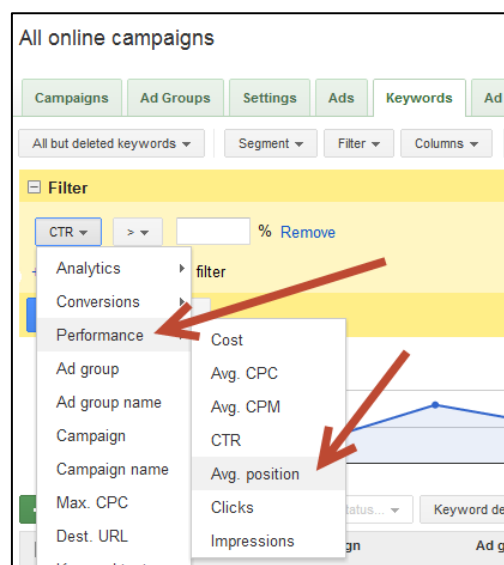
+ Add another
Save filter

Apply
Close

Average Keyword Position

You need to make sure the keywords which are triggering your ads are allowing them to achieve a strong average position on the page, so you are going to be seen and clicked on! To check the average position of your keywords I recommend using a date range of 14 days (change this in the top right-hand corner of the screen), then do the following:

1. Go to the Keywords tab
2. Click Filter
3. Click Create Filter
4. Choose Performance, and then Avg Position from the drop down menu.

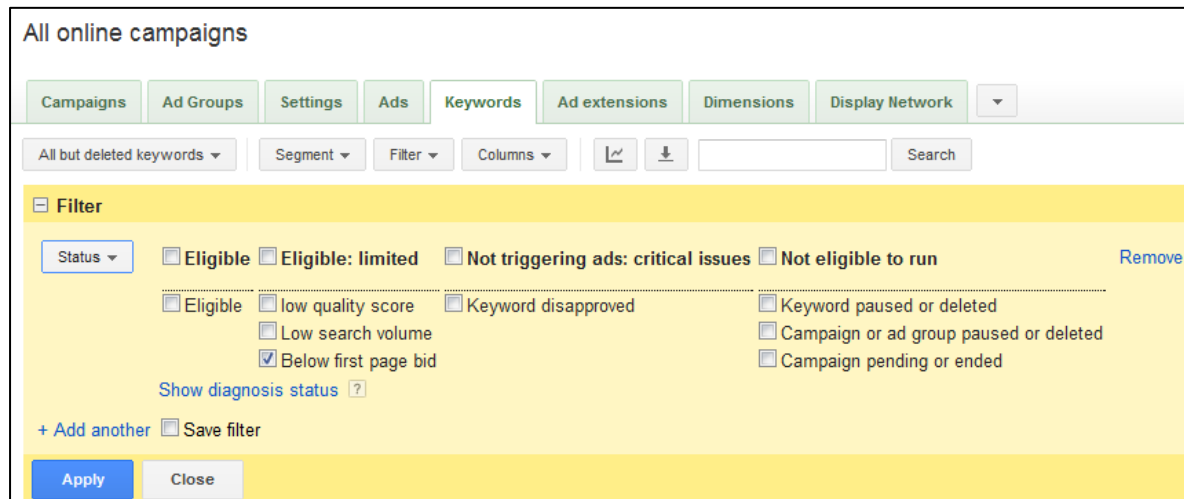


Depending on your budget and strategy, it's best to filter by anything with an average position worse than three. This is because anything below that is moving into the ad space on the right hand side of the search results page which will generally produce a much lower Click through Rate. You should be aiming for as high a CTR as possible because this will increase your Quality Score and may result in a reduction in your Cost per Click. If you have a lot of ads below position three, make sure your ad groups are as targeted as possible (aim for one keyword per ad group) and ensure your ads contain the keywords which are triggering them.

In particular, include the keyword in the ad title and display URL. Also check that the landing pages you are directing your ads to are the most appropriate for the keywords. Lastly you may simply need to bid higher to increase your average position. Increase your bids by a few pence and see if this improves them. Keep checking back regularly as the positions of ads can fluctuate significantly and it's something you should be keeping an eye on.

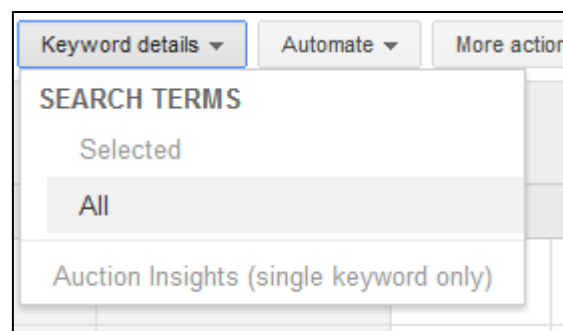
Keywords Below First Page Bid

If any of your keywords are below the first page bid recommended by Google, this will affect whether or not they are able to show on the first page of results. This should be checked in addition to checking the average position of your keywords because often keywords are picked up here which aren't shown when you filter by average position. This can only be done at keyword level so go to the keyword tab and then click Filter; Create, then Status, and select only the box which says Below First Page Bid.



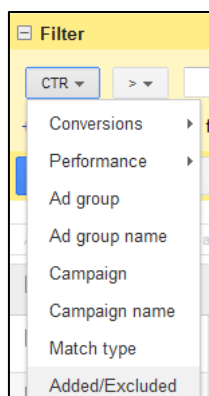
Search Query Analysis

This is about checking the things people are actually typing in to Google which are triggering your keywords and ads. To do this, go to the Keywords tab, and then click Keyword Details, and select all:



You can download this list to CSV if you would like to do some further filtering on it in a spreadsheet, which can make the process much quicker.

Look through the list for any words within the search queries which are not relevant and add these as negative keywords to the relevant ad groups or campaigns. This will stop your ads showing for irrelevant searches and gaining useless impressions which negatively impact your Quality Score. It will also stop you getting irrelevant clicks, saving your budget. To save time when you do this, filter by "Added / Excluded" and choose 'None'. This will make sure you only look through the terms that have not already been added or excluded as negative keywords.



You should also look for any new words within the search queries which are relevant to your product or service and can be added as a positive keyword. To help you find these quicker, you should order by terms which have generated conversions (click on the Conversions column header), or by those with a good Click through Rate (click on the CTR column header) if you don't have conversion tracking.

To speed up this process, you can filter within this report in the same way you can in other reports. One filter you might want to use is to only include terms with over 25 impressions. This is ideal if you are short of time and only want to deal with terms that are triggering your keywords enough to impact your account.

Make sure your date range is set over a long enough period of time to get a significant amount of data. I like to do this check on a weekly basis and look at the last seven days.

Keywords With A Low CTR

If a keyword has a particularly low CTR it may be damaging the Quality Score for the ad group it's in, and will result in a higher Cost per Click. To briefly check for keywords which have a particularly low CTR you can apply a filter at keyword level. You can apply it at ad group level if your keywords are very well split out with only one or two keywords per ad group. Assuming you apply it at keyword level, click the Keywords tab, then choose "Filter", "Create Filter". Choose "CTR" as your first criteria and then select the "less than" sign in the next box.

We would suggest filtering for anything with a CTR less than 1% as a starting point. To make sure you are only looking at live keywords you can add another filter for the keyword status and ensure only the "Eligible" and "Eligible Limited" columns are ticked. This will ensure you don't waste time looking through keywords which are already paused. You might also want to add a filter to only look at keywords with more than 100 impressions when you do this, so you know you are making decisions based on a decent amount of data. Use a date range of the last 20 days or so to get an idea of this, as keywords may have performed well in the past but are no longer performing well and this can skew the data if you are looking over an all-time date range.

To remedy a particularly low CTR, consider the relevancy of the keyword to the ad text in its ad group. Make sure the ad text contains the keyword within the heading. Is the average position of the keyword lower than three? You could try increasing the bid to counter this. If you have a good average position and the ad text is properly targeted and are still generating a poor CTR it might be that the keyword is simply too generic. In this instance you might want to pause it or at the very least split it into its own ad group so it's not pulling any other keywords down.

High Cost

If a keyword is using up a lot of your budget you want to be sure it's worth it. Go to the keywords tab and click the "Cost" column heading:

+ Add keywords

Edit

Change status...

Keyword details

Automate

More actions...

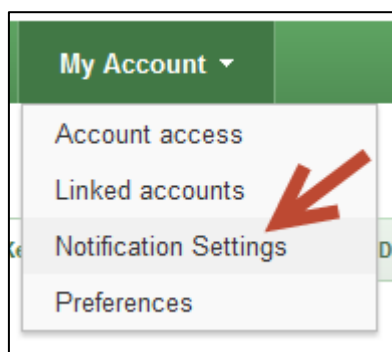
Labels

	Keyword	Campaign	Ad group	Status ?	Max. CPC	Clicks ?	Impr. ?	CTR ?	Avg. CPC	Cost ?
---	---------	----------	----------	----------	----------	----------	---------	-------	----------	--------

You can then see which keywords have used most of your budget. We recommend looking at this over the course of month or so to make sure you've got enough data to draw conclusions from. If a keyword is spending a lot, ask yourself if it has commercial intent and if you think it will be leading to sales or conversions. If the answer is yes, then it's worth keeping it running. Also look to see if it's ever generated conversions and what the cost per conversion has been. Based on the profit margins of your business you should be able to judge whether it's cost effective to leave that keyword running.

Email Alerts

Make sure you are set up to receive all the relevant alerts from the AdWords account so you can easily find out if there are any issues with the account without having to keep checking. To do this go to the My Account green tab, then click Notification Settings. Ensure your email address appears below where it says Notification Method. I recommend at the very minimum having Billing Alerts and Disapproved Ads and Policy Alerts selected for notification emails:



You don't need to check this every time you look at the account but it's important to make sure it's set up to start with so that you can keep track of any issues in the account without having to constantly check it.

Other important AdWords checks to make on a regular basis include:

- Check which keywords are delivering conversions
- Check that the landing page is relevant to the keyword you are bidding on
- Check the landing page has a quick loading speed
- Ensure your keyword is relevant to your ad copy used within the ad group
- Pause keywords with zero impressions over the last 3 months or more
- Amend ads with over 100 impressions but zero clicks
- Pause keywords with a high spend and no conversions
- Run daily search query reports to identify new keywords
- Run daily search query reports to identify new negative keywords
- Check which times of the day deliver conversions and alter bids accordingly
- Continually split test ad copy once both ads have has over 100 impressions
- Test the range of extensions available to see which works best
- Review first page bid estimates and bid accordingly
- Review the bounce rate of paid keywords in Google Analytics

Checking Adverts

When you want to see if your ad would appear on Google, use the Ad Preview tool instead of searching on the actual search engine, as this would otherwise waste impressions and damage your Quality Score. The tool works as if you were to search Google in real time but does not affect your Quality Score.

You can find the ad preview tool [here](#).

Ensure you have selected the right location settings that are applied to your campaigns, as well as devices and language. There is no time setting at the moment, so if your ad would not show at this time of day due to scheduling settings, it will not appear in the ad preview tool.

Summary

Thank you very much for reading this whitepaper. We do hope that you have taken some tips from it that you can put into practice.

AdWords is an extremely sophisticated advertising tool and there is no end to the different features to help you target potential customers.

Whilst the search network has proved to be the most profitable it is also worth experimenting with the Google Display Network. You can advertise with banners and videos across a wide range of sites. You can also implement remarketing which will advertise your product to users who have previously visited your site. We have a [separate whitepaper](#) that looks at these areas.

If you do need any further information or assistance, you can get in touch with us easily using any of the options below.



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